



On completion, St. Paul's Cathedral dominated the north bank of the Thames River. It remained the tallest building in London until 1962.

IN AN EXTENSION OF THE WAR OF THE SPANISH SUCCESSION

(see 1701–03) in South America, a squadron of French ships attacked Portuguese-held **Rio de Janeiro**, incapacitated Portuguese ships in the harbor, and only spared the city's defenses from destruction on payment of a ransom. French morale, which had been at a low since their withdrawal from the Battle of Malplaquet (see 1709), was raised by this proof that French long-range naval power had not been extinguished.

In North America, the **Tuscarora War** began in **North Carolina** between Tuscarora American Indians and settlers from Britain, Germany, and the Netherlands. The settlers and northern Tuscarora American Indians began to kidnap the Tuscarora in the south, sell them into slavery, and appropriate their lands. The southern Tuscarora retaliated in September with widespread attacks on settlements in which hundreds of settlers were killed.

In Asia, the Persian Safavid rulers of western **Afghanistan**



Losses at Rio de Janeiro

Caught unawares by a French naval attack in Rio de Janeiro harbor, Portuguese ships tried to escape. Three drifted aground, and one was destroyed by its crew.

moved to counter the uprising organized by Mirwais Khan Hotak (see 1709–10), but the Safavid army and its leader, Khosru Khan, were annihilated, and **Afghan independence** was secured.

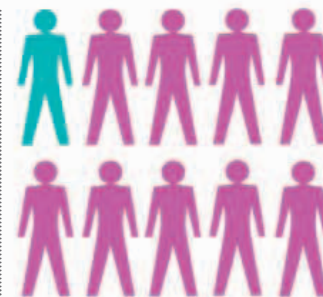
In December 1711, **St. Paul's Cathedral**, London's most iconic building, was completed. Designed by Christopher Wren, it was the fourth church to occupy its site; its predecessor was badly damaged in the Great Fire of London in 1666. The building had the **first triple dome** in the world: a light, timber-framed outer dome, supported by a hidden brick cone, and inside it, the inner dome that is visible from the interior.

Attack on Rio de Janeiro

French corsair René Duguay-Trouin's ships enter Rio de Janeiro harbor to salvage French honor—and profit at the same time.

“**RIGHT IS RIGHT, EVEN IF EVERYONE IS AGAINST IT; AND WRONG IS WRONG, EVEN IF EVERYONE IS FOR IT.**”

William Penn, founder of Pennsylvania, 1681



1:9 Smallpox epidemic

In the South African Cape, smallpox ravaged the native Khoisan population, killing nine people for every one survivor.

ON 7 JUNE 1712, **PENNSYLVANIA**, under moral pressure from its Quaker population, freed all the slaves in the state, an early step in the abolition of slavery. However, Queen Anne reversed the decision in the following year. Quaker state-founder and slaver trader William Penn (1644–1718) was not himself an opponent of slavery.

In **South Africa's Cape** region, Dutch sailors infected with **smallpox** inadvertently caused a catastrophic decimation of the native **Khoisan people** in 1713. The disease rapidly spread from laundrywomen infected by the sailors' dirty linen to the wider population because no one had immunity or medicine. The epidemic killed 90 percent

An end to war

This painting from the French royal almanac for 1714 shows signatories of the Treaty of Utrecht, which ended the War of the Spanish Succession.

February 24
German-born composer George Frideric **Handel** stages his opera *Rinaldo* in London

July 21 Treaty of Pruth ends Turco-Russian War (1710–11)

September 12 French squadron invades **Rio de Janeiro** harbor

September 22 First attacks on settlers by **Tuscarora** American Indians

October 26
Afghans annihilate Persian army at Kandahar

December 25
St. Paul's Cathedral completed

1712 **Pennsylvania** prohibits importation of slaves

1713 Britain begins supplying slaves to Spanish colonies after Spain signs **Asiento Agreement**

February 13, 1713
Dutch sailors inadvertently introduce **smallpox** to **Khoisan people** of South Africa's Cape

April 11, 1713 Final document of **Treaty of Utrecht** signed

July 13, 1713 Treaty of Portsmouth ends Queen Anne's War (began 1702) in America

July 27, 1714 Russian navy defeats the Swedes in **Battle of Gangut**